

simpleDocs

A small Windows assistant that explains selected code and technical text without pulling you away from your work.

Install once

- 1 Extract the ZIP, then open Install-simpleDocs.cmd. No administrator access, account, or sign-in is required.
- 2 simpleDocs installs under your Windows user profile, opens in the system tray, and starts automatically after future Windows sign-ins.
- 3 Select code, an error, terminal output, an equation, or technical text. Press Ctrl+Shift+Space and read the explanation.

Permanent Windows integration

The installer copies the app to a stable folder in your local Windows profile, adds a Start Menu shortcut, and registers it to start when you sign in. You do not need to reopen the downloaded ZIP after installation. Automatic startup can be disabled or re-enabled from the simpleDocs tray menu.

What it does

simpleDocs captures the text you select and, when available, a limited amount of nearby context. It sends that information to the hosted simpleDocs service, which streams a concise explanation back to the popup. The goal is to reduce repeated copying, searching, and switching between an editor, browser, terminal, and AI chat.

Using it well

Select the smallest complete line, block, message, or formula that represents your question. For errors, include the exact message and the most relevant stack-trace line. Browser equations work best when the formula itself is selected rather than surrounding controls.

Privacy and connectivity

Internet access is required. Selected text and nearby captured context are sent to the hosted service, so do not select passwords, API keys, personal records, or other sensitive information.

If the popup does not appear

Confirm that simpleDocs is visible in the Windows system tray, select the text again, and press Ctrl+Shift+Space once. If the problem continues, note the application, selected content type, app version, and what happened before contacting us.

Our research

simpleDocs grew from our presented paper, An OS-Level Contextual AI Assistant for Reducing Context Switching in Novice Programming Workflows. Our research explores whether useful explanations can appear inside a learner's current workflow, helping novice programmers stay focused while reading code, learning, and debugging.

Thank you for using our tool

Your experience and feedback will help me improve simpleDocs and continue this research. Kindly connect with me on LinkedIn and tell me what worked well or what could be better.

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